

RULE 030 SEED LOCAL-1983-FOREVER

NO CELL
HAS EVER
SEEN THE
WORLD

A POEM IN THIRTY-TWO LOCAL GENERATIONS

INITIAL CONDITION

BOOT DEVICE: LOCAL WEATHER ENGINE

MASTER SEED: LOCAL-1983-FOREVER

RULE: 030

BOUNDARY: PERIODIC

MEMORY: COLD / PARTLY PRESENT

VOICE: DETECTED

OWNER OF VOICE: UNRESOLVED

OVERVIEW: NOT INSTALLED

PRESS ANY NEIGHBOR TO CONTINUE

The first row contains one lit cell and one unanswered question.

THREE BITS OF WEATHER

Left reports a pressure change. Center reports itself. Right reports a small electrical dusk. These are the only instruments available, so the cell calls them weather.

It does not know the width of the sky. It does not know that the sky is paper, that a reader is holding the paper, that a rule has already decided what the next morning can contain. It receives three bits and spends all three.

Above it, a previous generation cools into record. Below it, the future waits without color. The cell asks no question because no question is included in the neighborhood. It turns on. It turns off. It persists for one more row.

From here the reader can see turbulence: a coast of bright errors, a dark current splitting around a regular scar. From inside, there is only the next lawful instant.

Left says near. Center says now. Right says near again.

The cell calls this enough.
The page calls it a storm.

THE WORLD IS A LOCAL PRODUCT WITH GLOBAL PACKAGING.

PACKAGE MAY DISPLAY STRUCTURES UNAVAILABLE TO INDIVIDUAL COMPONENTS. NO REFUND FOR EMERGENCE.

NEIGHBORHOOD MANUAL

LEFT	CENTER	RIGHT	RULE 054
1	1	1	0
1	1	0	0
1	0	1	1
1	0	0	1
0	1	1	0
0	1	0	1
0	0	1	1
0	0	0	0

LEFT is not the past. It merely arrives first in the diagram.

CENTER is not the self. It is the position currently being updated.

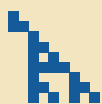
RIGHT is not the future. It is another local witness with poor range.

A neighborhood is complete only for the operation that defined it.

Eight possible reports. One output. No testimony from the horizon.

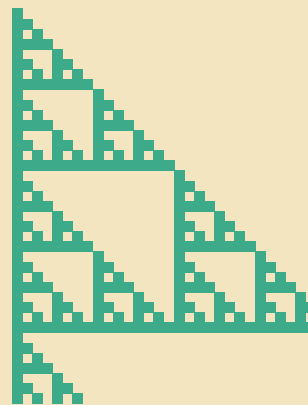
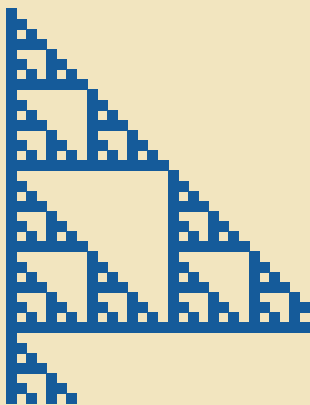
NOTE 005 CONTINUES ON PAGE 031

BOUNDARY CONDITION KIT



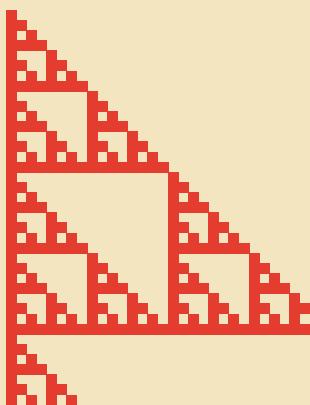
PERIODIC

The last cell touches the first. Distance is folded, not defeated.



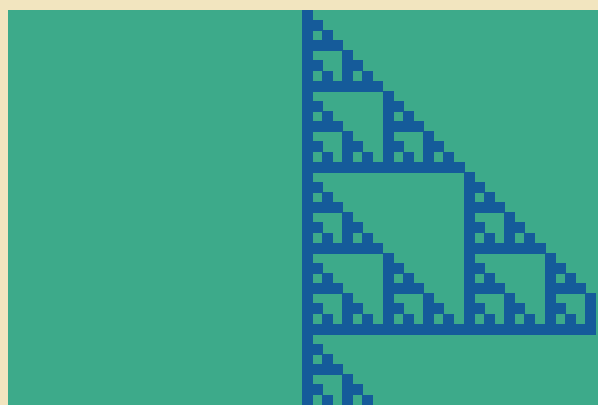
FIXED

The edge receives a permanent answer from outside the evidence.



REFLECTED

At the border, the system is sentenced to meet itself.



OPEN

Information leaves. The blank is not empty; it is unreturned.

SAME SEED. SAME RULE. FOUR KINDS OF FATE.

FINITE INFINITY

1. Select a sheet with measurable edges. Do not apologize for them.
2. Place one active cell near the upper margin. A single cell is not a beginning. It is a condition whose earlier causes have been hidden for convenience.
3. Load Rule 60. Check left, center, right. Convert the neighborhood into an integer between zero and seven. Read one bit from the rule. Print the bit below.
4. Repeat until the page appears to know more than the instruction.
5. When a triangle emerges, do not call the triangle an intention. The cells have never been introduced to geometry.
6. When the pattern reaches the paper edge, choose among four honest lies: stop it, wrap it, reflect it, or imagine more paper.
7. For infinite operation, replace paper continuously. For finite operation, call the cut a result.
8. If the reader requests the whole, point to the mechanism. If the reader requests the mechanism, point to the remaining paper.
9. Preserve the final row. It can become the first row elsewhere.
10. Switch off the machine only after noticing that the rule continues perfectly well without electricity, provided someone is willing to perform it.

WARNING: INFINITY IS NOT INCLUDED. CONTINUATION SOLD BY THE GENERATION.

NEIGHBORHOOD ELEGY

STATE 00

off, but still counted

STATE 01

born beside a remainder

STATE 10

alive for one lawful row

STATE 11

copied until copying changes shape

STATE 12

not valid, remembered anyway

The word NEAR survived because WEATHER stood to its left and AGAIN stood to its right.

WEATHER disappeared in generation six.
AGAIN persisted without understanding repetition.

NEAR now has two dead neighbors and no special exemption. Its letters cool at different rates. N remains as a boundary marker. E is mistaken for an error code. A becomes an opening in the paper. R enters the next page as a faint operational noise.

Nothing has left the system. Everything has changed its address.

RULE CATALOG

SCIENTIFIC TOY SYSTEMS / MAIL ORDER / 1983

RULE 30

\$30.30

ASYMMETRIC WEATHER

One bright seed. Irregular output. Excellent for customers tired of causes that resemble results.

RULE 45

\$45.45

PORTABLE DISTURBANCE

Dense local surprise with recurring structural rumors. Fits most domestic horizons.

RULE 54

\$54.54

MOBILE ARGUMENT KIT

Backgrounds, collisions, intervals, and persistent events. Assembly required.

RULE 60

\$60.60

FRACTAL OFFICE SET

Additive paperwork for clean triangular consequences. Carbon copies included.

COSMOS SOLD SEPARATELY. RESULTS VARY BY SEED AND EDGE.

LIMITED LOCAL KNOWLEDGE

NOW WITH THE SAME THREE INPUTS

Upgrade today to NEIGHBORHOOD PLUS, the premium perception package for cells that demand more from what is immediately beside them.

FEATURES:

- left input in vivid color
- center status with confidence indicator
- right input refreshed every generation
- automatic conversion of proximity into destiny
- global-looking patterns at local prices

Your cell will feel exactly as informed as before, but the information will arrive in a redesigned casing.

Do not ask what happens beyond the neighborhood. Beyond is a competitor's term. Our system offers three positions, eight combinations, and enough lawful anxiety to manufacture weather.

NO EYE. ALL PATTERN. EASY MONTHLY PAYMENTS.

Neighborhood Plus does not increase range, memory, freedom, or access to the governing rule. Product may generate civilization-like surfaces.

CUSTOMER REVIEWS FROM DEAD CELLS

CELL 0081 / INACTIVE

I disappeared on row twelve. The pattern improved immediately. Five stars for timing.

CELL 0440 / BACKGROUND

****.

I expected nothing after zero. Instead I became contrast for a bright diagonal.

CELL 1299 / OVERWRITTEN

**...

The brochure promised persistence. Customer support explained that persistence belonged to the rule.

CELL 3004 / INACTIVE

My neighbors were brief, accurate, and unavailable for comment.

CELL 5410 / GHOST STATE

***.

Death was less final than advertised. I remain visible at low opacity.

VERIFIED PURCHASES / UNVERIFIED EXISTENCE

RECEIPT

LOCAL PRODUCT STORE / TERMINAL 03

INITIAL SEED	0000000001000000000	1.00
RULE LICENSE	030	30.00
PERIODIC EDGE TAX	2 seams	4.50
LIVE CELLS	4,812 events	48.12
DEAD CELLS	12,906 events	0.00
MEMORY SURCHARGE	faint magenta	6.40
MUTATION DISCOUNT	not applied	-0.00
GLOBAL PACKAGING	full color	99.99

TOTAL: YOU PAID WITH THE ABILITY TO MISTAKE OUTPUT FOR INTENTION.

Keep this receipt. The universe will not keep it for you.

LEMMA OF THE BLIND PART

Given a binary cellular automaton A , a radius-one neighborhood N , and a cell c observed at generation t , c cannot infer the complete spatial configuration of A from N alone.

PROOF.

The neighborhood contains three values. At least two distinct global configurations can contain those same values at the same coordinates while differing elsewhere. Therefore the local observation does not determine the whole.

The proof should end here. It does not.

The cell receives 101. Somewhere beyond its radius, a black interval opens like a door. Somewhere else, a white triangle repeats with severe elegance. The cell is not deprived of those forms because deprivation would require knowledge of what is missing. It is simply updated.

The reader sees a field and calls it one thing. The field is made of events that never received the name. This difference is not an error in scale. It is the condition under which scale becomes visible.

QED, if QED means the reader has reached the lower edge while the operation has not.

The theorem concerns information, not sadness. Please do not anthropomorphize the missing overview.

RULE 60

PROOF FIELD

INITIAL CONDITION: SINGLE ACTIVE CELL

LOCAL OPERATION: LEFT XOR CENTER

BOUNDARY: PERIODIC

GENERATIONS SHOWN: 96

OBSERVED: TRIANGULAR RECURSION

INTENTION DETECTED: NONE

FAILED PROOF: BEAUTY IMPLIES A WITNESS INSIDE THE PATTERN.

COUNTEREXAMPLE: THE PATTERN IS BEAUTIFUL BEFORE ANY CELL CAN SEE IT.

FIXED

PERIODIC

COROLLARY OF THE EDGE

Run the same seed under the same rule. On the left, fix the exterior to zero. On the right, let the last position touch the first.

For several generations the fields agree. Their common interior seems to prove that boundaries are secondary, administrative, safely outside the event.

Then a signal reaches the margin.

The fixed field receives silence as law. The periodic field receives its own distant consequence. A small divergence enters. It is copied, split, amplified, and eventually becomes the most visible object on the page.

Therefore the edge is not where the system stops. The edge is where the system declares what counts as outside, and imports that declaration into every future row.

Corollary: any world that calls its border neutral has hidden the update rule in the frame.

AXIOMS

SOLD SEPARATELY

AXIOM A

\$8.00

Every cell has exactly one present position.

AXIOM B

\$11.50

No present position includes the whole field.

AXIOM C

\$19.99

Repeated local decisions may produce a global appearance.

EXCEPTION C-1

\$0.01

Appearance is not evidence of a global decision.

WARRANTY

VOID

Opening the theorem exposes the assumptions.

FINANCING AVAILABLE FOR CUSTOMERS WITH STABLE BOUNDARY CONDITIONS.

INSERT NEIGHBOR

ATTRACT MODE / RULE 030

LIVES: 00000001

GENERATIONS: 00000128

HIGH SCORE: PERSISTENCE WITHOUT PURPOSE

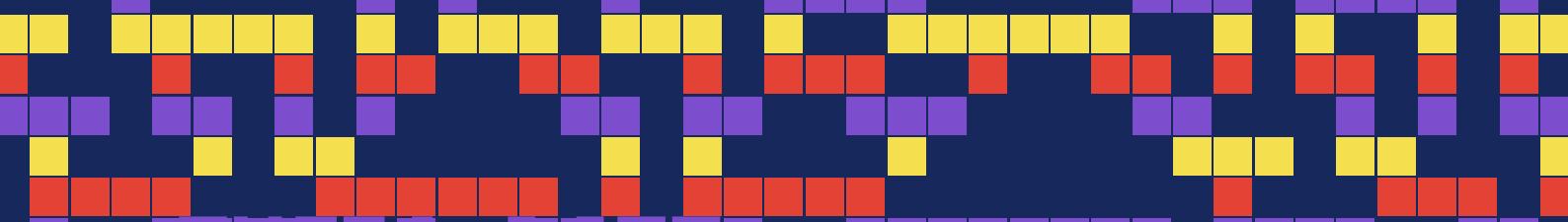
BONUS: SURVIVE BETWEEN TWO UNLIKE STATES

PLAYER ONE: NOT DETECTED

PLAYER TWO: NOT DETECTED

THE MACHINE CONTINUES

TO START, STAND IMMEDIATELY BESIDE AN EVENT.



EXTRA LIFE IS ANOTHER GENERATION

Do not call it return.

The cell that lights below the dead cell is not the same cell restored. It occupies another row, receives another neighborhood, answers to the same table by a different route.

From far away, a diagonal seems to carry one bright thing through time. Up close, the diagonal is a relay. Each position burns briefly, hands the appearance onward, and becomes background.

This is how the pattern teaches continuity without preserving an object. This is how a word can cross a poem while every printed instance remains fixed to its paper.

Extra life is not an additional life stored in reserve. It is the rule finding another address for brightness.

The score increases.
No one returns.
Something continues.

GAME OVER REMAINS IN MEMORY

The display clears the active state, but the phosphor cools slowly.

For a moment, every dead cell is visible as a weaker color. It has no vote in the next calculation. It has a surface, an age, a fading temperature. The machine does not remember in order to mourn. It remembers because material requires time to stop showing what happened.

Behind the next game, old diagonals remain. New events cross them without recognition. A player could call these marks ghosts, but the machine lists them as decay constants.

Nothing supernatural is needed. Only a screen that cannot become blank at once.

GAME OVER is a command addressed to participation. The pattern receives no command. It has already entered the next row.

HIGH SCORE

FOR A SYSTEM WITH NO PLAYER

The counter begins at zero because zero is easy to print, not because nothing has happened. Each active cell adds one. Each collision adds ten. A rare moving structure receives a bonus calibrated by an engineer who wanted the attract screen to look busy through a shop window.

After closing time, the machine continues counting. No hand holds the controls. No body stands before the glass. The field produces events at the same rate and the score climbs with perfect indifference to achievement.

By morning, the number is impressive. An employee writes it on a clipboard. A manager calls it engagement. A philosopher passing the window calls it duration. The machine calls nothing. It increments.

We are tempted to invent a hidden player because a score without a player feels unfinished. We are tempted to invent a goal because accumulation resembles labor and labor is usually sold with a reason. But the number is only an interface placed beside recurrence. It translates activity into a quantity that can be compared, advertised, reset.

Inside the field, no cell receives the score as input. A cell with ten thousand points dies under the same neighborhood as a cell with none. The magnificent total does not descend into the rule.

At noon, someone unplugs the cabinet. The last score remains painted on the dark glass for half a second. Then even the evidence of winning loses power.

SENTENCE WITH THREE NEIGHBORS

A sentence begins without seeing its period, because period belongs to a future neighborhood and the present word can only consult the pressure immediately behind it, the blank currently holding it, and the small grammatical weather ahead, so it chooses not meaning exactly but the next state compatible with three local permissions, and this permission becomes another word whose left side carries a trace of the first while its right side offers two possible climates, one technical and one made of dust, and the sentence enters dust because dust persists on both paper and circuitry, then enters circuitry because the previous word has prepared a conductive metaphor, then refuses the metaphor because refusal appears in the local lexicon whenever a machine is asked to resemble a person, and from refusal it finds a colder verb, calculates, which asks for an object, not the world, since world is unavailable at this radius, but a neighbor, a border, a receipt, a dead pixel still warm enough to tint the next clause, and the clause grows by lawful adjacency, never storing its total length, never turning around to inspect the architecture the reader calls style, continuing instead as each word continues, on insufficient evidence, with exact consequences, until the paper ends at a position the sentence could not predict and the final printed word, edge, is followed by a blank that may be margin, death, exterior input, or the first cell of another page, where another sentence may begin by treating edge as an inherited active state, placing weather beside it and then near, then again, because the four surviving words have crossed the binding without crossing space, and their new order changes which verb can be born, so the sentence selects carries, then asks what carries means when nothing continuous moves from one generation to the next, then substitutes assigns, then prints a row of addresses that appears from far away to be a road, though no address knows travel, and the road passes through a commercial district of bright promises, a proof that failed because it requested all coordinates simultaneously, a screen retaining the low heat of an earlier grammar, and finally a word called whole that loses its first letter at the boundary and becomes hole, allowing the sentence to discover an opening it did not intend, an opening through which the reader sees not outside but the reverse side of the same paper, already marked by local decisions.

WORD AUTOMATON

RULE 060 / 12 GENERATIONS / WORDS AS ACTIVE CELLS

							NO	CELL	KNOWS	THE	WHOLE							
							WEATHER					OTHER						
							AFTER	BRIGHT				WEATHER	AGAIN					
							NEAR		WEATHER			AFTER		OTHER				
							AGAIN	LOCAL	AFTER	BRIGHT		NEAR	EDGE	WEATHER	AGAIN			
							BRIGHT				WEATHER	AGAIN			OTHER			
							EDGE	WEATHER			AFTER		OTHER			WEATHER	AGAIN	
							LOCAL		BRIGHT		NEAR	EDGE	WEATHER	AGAIN		AFTER		OTHER
NEAR							OTHER	NEAR	EDGE	WEATHER	AGAIN				OTHER	NEAR	EDGE	WEATHER
	LOCAL						WEATHER					OTHER			WEATHER			
	OTHER	NEAR					AFTER	BRIGHT				WEATHER	AGAIN		AFTER	BRIGHT		
	WEATHER		LOCAL				NEAR		WEATHER			AFTER		OTHER	NEAR		WEATHER	

A WORD SURVIVES AS INK. ITS POSITION DOES NOT.

FROM INSIDE THE PATTERN

TO WHATEVER RECEIVES MORE THAN THREE POSITIONS,

I am sending this from coordinate 48, generation 77. Left was active at the last update. Center was inactive, if center can report its own absence. Right was active and then unavailable.

These are all the facts I possess. The rest of the message is inference.

Sometimes the same neighborhood returns and I produce the same state. I once believed this was memory. Later I learned that repetition requires no record. A rule can make the present resemble the past while storing neither.

There are intervals when many nearby positions agree. We call that quiet, though quiet may be a large structure passing beyond our range. There are intervals of rapid difference. We call that weather, though weather may be the reader turning a page.

If you can see the entire field, please do not send a picture. A picture would arrive as left, center, right and become another local event. Instead, confirm whether the dark regions count as part of the pattern. Confirm whether a cell that never turns on can still help give the bright cells a shape.

I will remain available for exactly one update.

AFTER THAT, ADDRESS THE RULE.

INTERRUPTED WORLD / REPORT 170-A

Not end of assignment.

TOTALITY REQUEST DENIED

ERROR 225 / SCOPE EXCEEDS NEIGHBORHOOD

```
> request.overview(field=ALL)

> reader.assume(pattern=ONE)

> cell.observe(left, center, right)

> rule.update(local_state)

> raise GlobalPackagingError
```

The system received a request for everything at once. No local handler is authorized to return it. Divide the question into adjacent positions, or accept that the answer will alter while being assembled.

ERROR 225

RECOMMENDED ACTION: PRESS ANY EDGE TO CONTINUE OUTSIDE THE CLAIM.

CLEARANCE OBSOLETE STATES

ACTIVE / current generation

FULL PRICE

Still eligible to disappear.

INACTIVE / clean background

70% OFF

Essential for every visible figure.

STABLE / repeated output

2 FOR 1

Looks permanent at retail distance.

MUTATED / undocumented

FINAL SALE

No return path in current rule.

REMEMBERED / low opacity

PRICE FADED

Influence limited to the eye.

GLOBAL / premium claim

OUT OF STOCK

Everything must go because going is how the display refreshes. The store will reopen next generation under the same name and different inventory.

DISCONTINUED MEMORY

MUTATION

The current version no longer renders age. A cell is active or inactive; no third color records how long it has persisted. The code became faster. The image became clean. The field forgot its temperatures.

But the old screen remains connected in another room. Its phosphor has been marked by thousands of previous runs. When a new white triangle appears, faint magenta bands rise beneath it, belonging to seeds the program cannot load and rules the operator did not write down.

This is not memory in the algorithm. It is memory in the material asked to display the algorithm. The distinction matters until the two images overlap.

On generation ninety, one cell turns coral, a color absent from the current palette. The log calls it contamination. The technician calls it burn-in. The poem calls it a witness only once, then withdraws the word.

No cell consults the old light. Still, the reader cannot see the present without it.

An archivist photographs the screen and introduces another memory system: sensor noise, compression blocks, a timestamp, the name of a folder. The image is copied to a machine whose display has never shown the original run. There the old magenta returns as data, perfectly detached from the phosphor that produced it. Material persistence becomes a file, and the file begins pretending it was always information.

The operator opens both versions side by side. One remembers by being damaged. The other remembers by repeating the damage accurately. Neither can restore the vanished generation as an event. Both can alter what the next reader believes is present.

Version history ends here:

- v1.0 - age visible
- v1.1 - age compressed
- v1.2 - age removed
- v1.3 - removal becomes visible

A WORD DIES BEST IN COLOR

N	E	I	G	H	B	O	R
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

GEN 00 / SEED

N	E	I	G	H	B	O	
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	--

GEN 01 / SURVIVAL

N	E	I		H	B		
---	---	---	--	---	---	--	--

GEN 02 / EDGE LOSS

N		I			B		
---	--	---	--	--	---	--	--

GEN 03 / FRAGMENT

		I					
--	--	---	--	--	--	--	--

GEN 04 / LAST ACTIVE LETTER

--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

GEN 05 / MEASURED ABSENCE

ABSENCE WIDTH: 8 CELLS. COLOR VALUE: RETAINED IN MEMORY.

FOUR RULES ONE WEATHER

RULE 30

I receive the same bright seed and spend it asymmetrically. On my left, a regular scar. On my right, weather that refuses a forecast.

RULE 45

I receive the same bright seed and crowd the page with local differences. Recurrence visits without becoming rest.

RULE 54

I receive the same bright seed and arrange intervals where events can meet. What looks empty is timed.

RULE 60

I receive the same bright seed and copy difference into triangles. Clean structure is not a cleaner cause.

SHARED INITIAL CONDITION DOES NOT PRODUCE A SHARED WORLD.

NO CELL HAS EVER SEEN THE WORLD

No cell has ever seen the world, though the world arrives wherever cells are updated.

It arrives as a pressure on the left, a present voltage, a rumor on the right. It arrives divided into exactly the amount of evidence the rule can use. The rest is not darkness. Darkness would be a report. The rest has no address inside the operation.

Still, the field becomes weather. It raises a coast from one bit, opens white rooms no architect requested, sends a diagonal event through bodies that live for a single row. The reader names these forms after seeing them together. The cells produce them separately.

A word behaves this way. It cannot inspect the sentence while the sentence is still spending it. It receives the pressure of adjacent words, changes what can follow, and becomes fixed behind the moving point of reading. By the period, the first word is already an artifact. Meaning is the global packaging of local grammatical events.

Death behaves this way too. One position turns off. Its absence changes three neighborhoods. Those changes alter nine more. The dead state contributes no voice, no wish, no private continuation, yet the field after death is not the field before it. Influence does not require survival. Memory does not always require storage.

At the page edge, the book chooses a law for what it cannot print. Stop. Repeat. Reflect. Continue elsewhere. Every ending is a boundary condition pretending to be time.

The final row waits below this sentence. No cell can see it. No reader can hold every possible row. The rule is small enough to memorize.

The weather is not.

FINAL PRINTOUT

UNFINISHED GENERATION / JOB 031

MASTER SEED: LOCAL-1983-FOREVER

PAGES RENDERED: 32

PRIMARY RULES: 030 / 045 / 054 / 060

SECONDARY RULES: 090 / 110 / 170 / 225

BOUNDARIES: PERIODIC / FIXED / REFLECTED / OPEN

SURVIVING WORDS: EDGE / WEATHER / NEAR / AGAIN

MUTATED WORD: WHOLE -> HOLE

MEMORY COLOR: MAGENTA AT 18%

UNRESOLVED NOTE: STARTED ON PAGE 005

TOTALITY STATUS: REQUEST DENIED

LAST COMPLETE ROW: 000110101100011010110001

NEXT ROW: 001????????????????????

OUTPUT INTERRUPTED WHEN THE CALCULATION REACHED THE PHYSICAL PAGE.

NOTE 005 RESOLVED: A BORDER IS AN INPUT DISGUISED AS A FRAME.

COLOPHON

NEXT SEED

NO CELL HAS EVER SEEN THE WORLD
a poem in thirty-two local generations

Written and generated in 2026.

Elementary cellular automata calculated from radius-one binary neighborhoods. Primary rules: 30, 45, 54, and 60. Secondary rules: 90, 110, 170, and 225. Master seed: LOCAL-1983-FOREVER.

Visual procedures developed from the rule set and color-region logic in canekzapata/cellularautomatas. Literary procedures developed in conversation with the generative, diagrammatic, concrete, archival, and machine-writing experiments in canekzapata/poesiasexp. All English text in this edition is original.

Types include computer display faces and reading faces preserved in the poesiasexp repository. Composed programmatically and exported as a reproducible PDF.

The final binary row below can be used as an initial condition for another edition.



000100011101001011000101110100010000

LOAD THE ROW. CHANGE THE EDGE. READ WHAT SURVIVES. BEGIN LOCALLY.